ENG509 Final Subjective

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2K25

Name any three 'head movement' in syntax?

In syntax, "head movement" refers to the process of moving a word or phrase to a position where it can serve as the head of a phrase. Here are three examples of head movement:

1. **Verb movement**: In some languages, verbs move to a higher position in the sentence to mark tense or agreement.

2. **Auxiliary inversion**: In English, auxiliary verbs like "will" or "can" move to the beginning of a sentence to form a question.

3. **Wh-movement**: In questions, wh-words like "who", "what", or "where" move to the beginning of the sentence to mark the question.

Wh-questions?

Questions which ask for a particular piece of information, rather than for simply Yes or No, are called wh-questions. We call them wh -questions because they are often introduced by a word (or phrase) beginning with wh-.

wh-questions

(I) Where did John hide the money?

(2) What did she say?

(3) When did he come back?

(4) Which girl did Bill like best?

(5) Who(m) did you meet there?

- However, the wh-word does not always open the question.
- It may also appear inside the first constituent of the sentence:

Inside wh-question

(6) For what reason did you leave early?

(7) In what way did John offend her?

(8) At what distance were you from that spot?

what is Superfluous information?

Superfluous information refers to unnecessary, excessive, or redundant details that do not add meaning or value to a message, text, or conversation.

- **Using unnecessary words:** "I'm going to the store, and I will buy some milk."

(Superfluous word: "and I will")

- **Providing irrelevant details**: "I went to the park, which is located on Main Street, and I saw a dog."

(Superfluous detail: "which is located on Main Street")

- **Repeating information:** "I'm going to the store. The store is where I'm going."

(Superfluous sentence: "The store is where I'm going")

- **Using unnecessary phrases:** "To be honest with you, I don't like that movie."

(Superfluous phrase: "To be honest with you")

types of Constituents?

In linguistics, a constituent is a unit of language that consists of a group of words that function together as a single unit. Here are the main types of constituents:

1) Phrasal Constituent
2) Null Constituent
3) Clausal Constituent
4) Lexical Constituent
5) immediate constituents

Modal verb?

Modal verbs are auxiliary verbs that express modality, which includes notions such as possibility, necessity, obligation, permission, ability, and prediction. Here are the main modal verbs in English:

1. Can

2. Could

3. May

4. Might

5. Shall

6. Should

7. Will

8. Would

9. Must

To identify modal verbs, look for the following characteristics:

- They are used to express modality (possibility, necessity, obligation, etc.).

- They are auxiliary verbs, meaning they are used to help form the tense, mood, or voice of another verb.

- They often have multiple meanings and uses.

Examples:

- "I can speak French." (ability)

- "You must try this cake." (obligation)

- "It might rain tomorrow." (possibility)

critical components of reading instruction?

the **five critical components** of reading instruction which include

- phonemic awareness
- decoding
- fluency
- vocabulary
- comprehension

3 semantic constraints?

Semantic constraints refer to the rules or restrictions that govern the meaning of words, phrases, or sentences in a language. Here are three types of semantic constraints:

1) Selectional Restrictions
2) Presuppositional Constraints
3) Implicational Constraints

These semantic constraints help to ensure that language is used in a way that is meaningful, coherent, and consistent with the context.

Embedded sentence?

An embedded sentence, also known as a subordinate clause or embedded clause, is a sentence that is nested inside another sentence. It functions as a single unit within the larger sentence.

Examples:

1. I know that she is coming. (The embedded sentence is "that she is coming.")

2. The book, which is on the table, is mine. (The embedded sentence is "which is on the table.")

Embedded sentences often begin with subordinating conjunctions, such as:

- because

- since

- after

- although

- if

- that

- which

- who

Theory of X bar?

X-bar theory is a theory of syntactic category formation. It embodies **two independent claims**:

One, that phrases may contain **intermediate constituents** projected from a head X; Two, that this system of projected constituency may be common to more than one category (e.g., N, V, A, P, etc.). The letter X is used to signify an arbitrary lexical category (part of speech); When analyzing a specific utterance, specific categories are assigned. The X may become an N for noun, a V for verb, an A for adjective, or a P for preposition. The term X-bar is derived from the notation representing this structure. Certain structures are represented by X^{-} (an X with a bar over it). X may be often written as X', using the **prime symbol** or with superscript numerals as exponents, e.g., X^{1}. In English this is still read as "X bar".

The notation XP stands for X phrase, and is at the equivalent level of X-bar-bar (X with a double over bar), written X" or X2 , usually read aloud as X double bar. X-bar theory was first proposed by Noam Chomsky (1970) building on Zellig Harris's 1951 approach to categories, and further developed by Ray Jackendoff (1977). X-bar theory was incorporated into both transformational and nontransformational theories of syntax, including GB,etc. Recent work in the Minimalist Program has largely abandoned Xbar schemata in favor of bare phrase structure approaches.

T-C Movement?

T-C Movement refers to the transformation of a sentence from a statement to a question, or vice versa, by changing the position of the auxiliary verb (T) and the subject (C).

To form a question using T-C Movement, you would typically:

1. Start with a statement: "He is going to the store."

2. Move the auxiliary verb (T) to the beginning of the sentence: "Is he going to the store?"

This transformation changes the sentence from a statement to a question. The subject (C) "he" moves to the right of the auxiliary verb (T) "is".

T-C Movement is an important concept in linguistics, as it helps to explain how questions are formed in English and other languages.

What is Clefting?

Clefting is a device which is used to focus on a particular constituent in the sentence. The process of clefting involves extracting a constituent from its basic position in the sentence and putting it in a more prominent position.

Write any five types of Cleft in English?

1) It-cleft
2) Wh-cleft/Pseudo-cleft
3) Reversed wh-cleft/Inverted pseudo-cleft
4) All-cleft
5) Inferential cleft
6) There-cleft
7) If-because cleft